

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 2 Handout — When to click vs when to script

Learning in public · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

What you will understand today

- **Portal** — best for exploration and visual confirmation
- **Azure CLI (az)** — best for repeatable, pipeline-friendly commands
- **PowerShell** — best when you need objects and Windows-centric automation
- **Naming** — rg-day02-lab beats New Resource Group (1)

High-level architecture — choose your interface

Decision table — pick the tool by the job

Job	Portal	Azure CLI	PowerShell
First time seeing a service	Best	OK	OK
Same task twice this week	Avoid	Best	Best
Put it in a pipeline later	No	Best	Good
Need structured objects	Limited	Text/JSON	Best
Windows estate / AD-heavy	OK	Good	Best

Architecture — all three tools talk to the same plane

Step	What happens
1. You	Decide the change (create RG, list resources, ...)
2. Portal / CLI / PowerShell	Your interface — clicks or commands
3. Azure Resource Manager	Control plane that accepts the request (Day 3)
4. Azure resource providers	Actually create/update the resource

One-liner to remember

Explore once in Portal · Second time use CLI · Forever after, script it

Step-by-step lab (20–30 min)

Use a **personal** Microsoft account and personal Azure subscription only.

- 1 Install Azure CLI: <https://aka.ms/installazurecliwindows>
- 2 Run **az login** and select your personal subscription.
- 3 Create resource group: **az group create --name rg-day02-lab --location centralindia**
- 4 Optionally create one RG in the Portal to feel the click cost.
- 5 List with **az group list --output table**, then delete lab RGs.

Commands

```
az login
az account set --subscription "<name-or-id>"
az group create --name rg-day02-lab --location centralindia
az group show --name rg-day02-lab --output jsonc
az group list --output table
az group delete --name rg-day02-lab --yes --no-wait
```

Done checklist

- I can explain Portal vs CLI vs PowerShell in one line each
- az login works on my personal machine
- I created (and cleaned up) rg-day02-lab

Tomorrow — Day 3

Azure Resource Manager (ARM) — the control plane behind every click and command.